

Project | CeraVe SEO Research

Brand Overview: As the global brand team behind CeraVe, our mission is to make dermatologist-developed skincare accessible to all. "CeraVe for All" reflects our promise to every skin type, age, and lifestyle. Our formulas are barrier-restoring, clinically backed, and easy to understand—no fluff, just real results.

Campaign Objective: We know that for many men, skincare starts with a Google search. This campaign is about showing up at that exact moment with helpful, search-optimized content. By creating blog posts that match Carlos's questions and concerns, we can build trust, drive discovery, and connect him to CeraVe solutions in a way that feels natural and credible.

Target Audience: We're targeting [Carlos – The Practical Skincare Researcher \(click for persona details\)](#), a 36-year-old Latino man who uses Google to solve skincare problems like dryness or product confusion. Carlos represents a high-intent, underserved audience segment that prefers functional, science-backed solutions. He's not active on Instagram or TikTok, so SEO and YouTube are essential to reaching him.

Blog Content Focus: Carlos turns to search engines to educate himself, compare options, and find simple routines. Search-optimized blog content gives us the opportunity to answer his questions, introduce helpful solutions, and earn his trust early in his skincare journey.

Project Tasks

1. Research & Prep

If we're going to meet Carlos where he searches, we need to speak his language—and that starts with the right keywords. Start by getting familiar with CeraVe’s brand voice and the [Skin Smarts blog](#). Research how CeraVe speaks to men, and get to know Carlos, the target persona (linked [here](#)). Analyze his pain points, search habits, and priorities— your keyword strategy and blog content should speak directly to him.

2. Keyword Research

Review the keyword list below and expand it by **adding at least 10 new keywords**. Aim for high-intent keywords Carlos is likely searching. Use tools like Google Trends and Semrush to analyze the best keywords and uncover additional ideas. You may use the methods suggested by Rita in videos but **NOT AI**.

Notes:

- The first 10 keyword ideas are provided. You’ll add 10+ more keyword ideas.
- Fill in the table’s columns for all 20+ keywords
- TREND should be researched on Google trends
- VOLUME, KD, and INTENT should be researched on Semrush

(Fill out the table and add keywords below 🖐)

	KEYWORD BRAINSTORM <i>(10 provided, you need to add 10+)</i>	TREND	VOLUME	DIFFICULTY (KD)	INTENT
1	how to start a skincare routine for men	Flat ▾	30	35%	Informational
2	best skincare products for men 2025	Down ▾	10	N/A	N/A
3	is cerave good for men	Up ▾	20	N/A	N/A

	KEYWORD BRAINSTORM (10 provided, you need to add 10+)	TREND	VOLUME	DIFFICULTY (KD)	INTENT
4	face wash steps for beginners	No Data ▾	0	N/A	N/A
5	cerave vs cetaphil cleanser	Up ▾	2.9K	30%	Commercial
6	how to treat dry skin without moisturizer	Flat ▾	20	N/A	N/A
7	best drugstore skincare routine for men	No Data ▾	0	N/A	N/A
8	what causes flaky skin on face	Flat ▾	110	47%	Informational
9	fragrance free skincare for sensitive skin	Flat ▾	320	8%	Informational
10	how to pick the right cleanser	Flat ▾	20	N/A	N/A
11	how many skincare products do I need	Flat ▾	20	N/A	N/A
12	how long does it take to see skincare results	Up ▾	20	N/A	N/A
13	best cleanser for sensitive skin	Up ▾	1.6K	37%	Commercial
14	morning vs night skincare routine	Up ▾	110	11%	Informational, Commercial
15	how to stop dry skin on face	Flat ▾	70	28%	Informational
16	gentle face wash for men	Down ▾	140	35%	Informational, Commercial
17	is cerave good for sensitive skin	Down ▾	210	48%	Informational
18	easy skincare routine for beginners	Flat ▾	10	44%	Informational

	KEYWORD BRAINSTORM (10 provided, you need to add 10+)	TREND	VOLUME	DIFFICULTY (KD)	INTENT
					nal
19	best ingredients for skincare	Down ▾	30	37%	Informational
20	acne skincare for men	Flat ▾	40	11%	Informational
		No Data ▾			
		No Data ▾			

Blog 1: What Causes Flaky Skin on Your Face and How You Can Repair it

Keywords used: what causes flaky skin on face, how to stop dry skin on face, fragrance free skincare for sensitive skin, is cerave good for sensitive skin

If your face has been dry and flaky recently, not to worry, it's a common frustration for a lot of men. It's one of the most frequent skin problems they face, especially if your whole routine consists of just soap and water. Let's quickly discuss what causes flaky skin on the face and, more importantly, how to rejuvenate it.

Indications of Flaking Skin

Flaking usually means your skin's barrier is compromised. Your skin naturally has lipids (ceramides included) that keep moisture in and irritants out. When that barrier gets damaged, whether it's from harsh soap, hot showers, cold weather, or general irritation, your skin loses water faster than it can replace it. That's why you end up with tightness, rough patches, and flaking, usually around your cheeks, nose, and jawline first.

Shaving can make things worse too. Every time you shave, you're creating tiny bits of trauma on your skin's surface, and if you're not following up with the right products afterward, that damage adds up over time.

How to Stop Dry Skin on Your Face

Fixing dry skin isn't complicated but it requires a high degree of consistency. This is what it takes:

- Change your cleanser. Foaming cleansers with sulfates strip your skin's natural oils, which makes flaking worse over time. Opt for something fragrance-free and gentle instead.
- Moisturize immediately after cleansing. Putting moisturizer on damp skin traps more hydration than waiting until your skin's totally dry. Give it 60 seconds after washing, then apply.
- Utilize ceramides and hyaluronic acid. These help rebuild your barrier and actually pull moisture into your skin instead of just sitting on top of it.
- Avoid hot water. It feels good, but it dries you out fast and breaks down your skin's natural oils. Lukewarm is the move, even if it's a little less satisfying in the shower.

Why Fragrance-Free is Important

If your skin's already irritated or flaky, fragrance-free skincare for sensitive skin purely a convenience. Added fragrance is one of the biggest reasons people get irritation, redness, and breakouts, especially when their skin is already struggling to repair itself. Going fragrance-free takes one more variable off the table that could be making things worse without you realizing it.

Is CeraVe Good for Sensitive Skin?

A lot of men wonder if CeraVe is good for sensitive skin when they start researching solutions for their skin. The answer is a definitive yes. Products are made in collaboration with dermatologists specifically for sensitive, damaged skin. The formulas use three ceramides your skin already makes naturally, plus hyaluronic acid for hydration. Additionally, most products are fragrance-free and non-comedogenic which means they won't clog pores or trigger new breakouts while your skin heals.

If flaky or irritated skin is a frequent issue for you, a few simple changes can make a dramatic difference. Switching to products that are gentle and reinforce the skin barrier can make strides in just a few weeks, all with no complicated routine.

Blog 2: How to Choose the Right Cleanser for Your Skin (CeraVe vs. Cetaphil)

Keywords used: best cleanser for sensitive skin, cerave vs cetaphil cleanser, gentle face wash for men, fragrance free skincare for sensitive skin

If you walk down any skincare aisle and you'll see a wall of cleansers all labeled with the words "gentle" or "for sensitive skin." So how do you actually know which one to grab without wasting money on something that doesn't work for you? If you're dealing with dryness or irritation, or just want to stop overthinking the pick, there are a number of factors you should consider before making a purchase.

What Defines a Gentle Cleanser

A real gentle face wash for men should clean your skin without ruining it in the process. That means no sulfates and no added fragrance as fragrance is a major cause of facial irritation, even in products marketed as sensitive-skin-friendly. Look for "non-comedogenic" on the label, which basically means it won't clog your pores, and check for ingredients that actually support your skin barrier instead of just stripping everything off your face.

CeraVe vs. Cetaphil Cleanser

If you've been contemplating between CeraVe vs. Cetaphil cleanser, that's certainly a fair dilemma. Both brands are dermatologist-recommended and easily accessible within any drugstore. Here's the basic comparison for both:

- What's in it: CeraVe products rely on three essential ceramides plus hyaluronic acid. This means it's cleaning your skin while also trying to repair your barrier at the same time. Cetaphil tends to keep things more minimal, with fewer added ingredients overall to reduce potential irritation.

- Options: CeraVe has a bunch of specific formulas depending on what you're dealing with. This includes a foaming gel for normal-to-oily skin, a hydrating cleanser for dry skin, and even a salicylic acid version for rough or bumpy texture. You can actually match a formula to your specific issue instead of using any general-use product.
- Sensitive skin: Both brands work fine for sensitive skin, but if you're dealing with visible dryness or flaking on top of sensitivity, the ceramide-based option might be slightly more beneficial for you.

Neither one is objectively "better" in general. As a result, it really just comes down to what your particular skin needs at the moment.

How to Actually Test a New Cleanser

Give a new cleanser two to three full weeks before deciding whether it's working or not. Your skin needs time to adjust to anything new, and switching products too fast blurs the line between its effectiveness and what is simply just due to a coincidence. Make sure to pay attention to how your face feels post-cleansing to ensure products are effective. If you experience a tight and dry feeling, it usually means the formula's too harsh, while comfortable and balanced means you've found an excellent choice (and you should continue using it).

Getting your cleanser right is the foundation everything else in your routine builds on. Simply mastering this single step, and the rest of your routine, moisturizer, sunscreen, will complement it.

Blog 3: A Simple Skincare Routine for Men (Morning vs. Night)

Keywords used: morning vs night skincare routine, how to start a skincare routine for men, acne skincare for men

If you've never had a real skincare routine before, it can feel overwhelming with the mountain of products out there, serums, toners, exfoliants, you name it, to the point you give up before you even start. There is some good news however: figuring out how to start a skincare routine for men doesn't have to be complicated because it's much simpler

than you think. A few steps done consistently will get you way further than a 10-product routine you end up abandoning after a week.

Why Morning and Night Are Actually Different

Understanding the morning vs. night skincare routine split makes this whole thing much easier to grasp. During the day, your skin's main job is dealing with external factors, sun exposure, pollution, and general environmental stress. At night, your skin enters repair mode while you sleep, which is why nighttime is the optimal moment to introduce ingredients like retinol that your skin can handle without needing sun protection layered on top.

Morning Routine (3 Steps)

- **Cleanse.** A gentle, non-comedogenic face wash clears out overnight oil buildup without stripping your skin.
- **Moisturize.** A lightweight, hydrating moisturizer keeps your barrier supported all day, even if you're outside or in a dry office.
- **Sun-protection.** Finish with broad-spectrum SPF 30 or higher. This step is often overlooked, but is arguably one of the most important, as sun damage is the single biggest cause of premature aging and uneven skin tone over time.

Night Routine (2-3 Steps)

- **Cleanse again.** Wash away the day's dirt, oil, and sweat before bed, even if your face doesn't look that dirty (many of these things are not visible).
- **Targeted Treat (optional).** If you're dealing with something specific on your acne, dark spots, texture, this is where a targeted product should enter the equation.
- **Moisturize.** A richer night cream helps your skin repair and stay hydrated while you sleep.

What If Acne Is Your Main Concern?

If breakouts are the main issue you're dealing with, acne skincare for men works best as long as you don't overdo it. A cleanser containing the ingredient known as salicylic acid

helps clear out pores and reduce breakouts. This doesn't mean you should layer a bunch of active ingredients together simultaneously as that usually irritates your skin. Along with the acne treatment step, you should add a lightweight moisturizer so that your skin doesn't overcompensate by producing even more oil.

Consistency Over Complexity

The biggest mistake men make when starting out is switching products too fast or piling on too many steps all at once, usually because they unreasonably expect results to come immediately. Use something simple for several weeks minimum before deciding whether it's actually working because skin needs sufficient time to adjust and reveal any results. Jumping between products before giving them a fair shot may cost you instead of improving your condition.

A ten-step routine is never necessary to achieve fair skin. You just need to pair a basic routine with everyday commitment and the results will follow.

4. Reflect and Prepare

Write up a 3-5 sentence answer to the following interview question:

"How would you approach writing blog content differently now that Google is using AI overviews at the top of search results?"

Aim for your answer to demonstrate your adaptability, understanding of how AI is impacting the SEO industry, and flexible mindset. If you need a refresher, return to the HQ page about AI and SEO, or read this recommended [Wordstream article](#).

(Paste or write your answer below 📌)

AI overviews today excel in answering basic questions directly in search results. This means I'd change my strategy to focus less on competing for common, typical informational queries and more on specific details that AI has a harder time replicating. Rather than writing something like "how to start a skincare routine," I'd probably address certain skin concerns in more detail, since those are harder for AI to answer and more likely to catch a scanning user's attention. Readers probably don't fully trust AI's ability to recommend skincare, so a professional opinion would likely be much more sought after. I'd also look to rely on quotes from actual dermatologists, expert insights, and the reputation of brands, since readers (and Google) tend to favor writing that actually shows expertise instead of just hitting keywords. Finally, I'd write assuming some readers already saw an AI summary before clicking through. That means my content needs to bring something extra, whether that's a deeper explanation, a specific recommendation, or an answer to a normal follow-up question they still have.

5. LevelUp on LinkedIn (Optional, **10pt Extra Credit**)

Draft a short LinkedIn post about what you've learned while working on CeraVe's SEO strategy. Think about how this project has deepened your understanding of SEO, keyword research, or audience targeting. You could also mention how you approached optimizing a product page for a real-world brand and customer persona, any tools (like Semrush, Google Trends, or ChatGPT) you used, or any challenges you overcame when working on the project. Referencing what you learned about SEO and AI may also help position you as a savvy, adaptable professional ready for a changing landscape.

Consider adding media, such as a screenshot of your keyword list or your blog content to increase engagement and showcase your work.

Actually posting this on LinkedIn is optional, but highly recommended! As you know, recruiters and potential employers love to see posts that showcase your learning, ambition, and experience.

Please paste the text of your LinkedIn post below. *Do not paste screenshots or URLs!*

(Paste or write your LinkedIn post content below 📌)

